A BRIEF INTRODUCTION

TO THE

MORENTHIAN GRAMMAR



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Glossing Abbreviations

__.F	Female pronoun
__.M	Male pronoun
__.N	Neuter pronoun
.adj	Adjective
.EXCL	Exclusive
.INCL	Inclusive
.n	Noun
.POST	Postposition
ADP	Adposition phrase marker
ATEL	Atelic
CLF	Classifier
FOR	Formal
GEN	Genitive: possessive marker
INF	Informal
NW	Non-witness/hearsay evidentiality
PL.HUM	Plural particle for groups of people
PL.OBJ	Plural particle for other objects
RCP	Reciprocal
WIT	Witness evidentiality

*See table 4 for the glossing abbreviations of tenses.

1 Introduction

Morenthian (*morensyeur* [moʁənsjøχ]) is an artlang that I have been developing for world-building purposes. It is an a priori language designed to be spoken by a group of humans in a fictional world. The setting for the conworld is similar to the real world, so I mostly aim to create a sense of naturalism in Morenthian.

The original plan is to create a head-final (at least somewhat) analytic language with limited agglutination and inflection. I have referenced analytic languages such as Mandarin and head-final languages such as Japanese for inspiration when dealing with syntax. In terms of phonology, I would not claim to have formally referenced any natural languages, with only minimal attempts at including consonant clusters that sound subjectively pleasant to me (I had the idea of using Germanic languages as inspiration, but I was not confident enough to borrow from or reference them). Essentially, the goal is to make Morenthian enough naturalistic and aesthetically fitting for the constructed world. I hope it does not look too Indo-European flavoured, though there wasn't an attempt to actively avoid Indo-European influences (half of the inventory was copied from French in its early stages, after all). These are the goals I have set in the first assignment, and I would say they were followed pretty consistently.

In the conworld, Morenthian is spoken mostly by inhabitants of Uroria (also referred to as the East Continent). It is the official language of the United Urorian Federation, officially named Standard Morenthian. Morenthian is the most spoken language in the conworld, with a large population of L2 speakers in the west continent, Hiroiith. The conworld is modelled very similarly to the real world, and the goal is that Morenthian will appear even naturalistic to us. In its setting, some other languages are related to Morenthian and share the same language family (which may become future projects, if ambitiously speaking). Limerant Morenthian (tentatively named Limerese) is a descendant of Old Morenthian. The original Morenthian-speaking people who followed a prophecy to search for the island of Limerant on a ship eventually found and settled on the isolated island, and lived without any contact with the mainland for some 500 years as it was physically impossible to cross the channel again. We would expect the language to diverge in very different directions and evolve into separate languages due to the complete absence of contact.

The description here will be a very rough sketch of the most current version of Morenthian. Many aspects of the conlang, as well as the conworld, are largely underdeveloped; but it has

been over four years since the very first day I started working on the creation of Morenthian, long hiatus were taken, and as of now, at least some progress has been made.

2 PHONETICS & PHONOLOGY

2.1 Phoneme inventory[1]

Vowels	Front		Near-front	Central	Back	
Close	[i]¹	y				u
Near-close			ɪ			
Close-mid	e	ø				o
Mid				ə		
Open-mid	ɛ	[œ]²			[ʌ]³	[ɔ]⁴
Open	a				ɑ	

1. allophone of /ɪ/
2. allophone of /ø/
3. allophone of /ɑ/
4. allophone of /o/

Table 1: Vowels in Morenthian

Consonants	Bilabial		Labio-dental		Dental		Alveolar		Post-Alveolar		Palatal		Velar		Uvular		Glottal	
Nasal		m						n				ɲ		ŋ		[ɴ]¹		
Plosive	p	b					t	d					k	g				
Fricative			f	v	θ		s	z	ʃ	[ʒ]²	[ʂ]³				[χ]⁴	ʁ	h	
Affricate							t͡s		t͡ʃ									
Lateral approximant								l										
Approximant												j						

1. allophone of /n/
2. allophone of /g/
3. allophone of /s/
4. allophone of /ʁ/

Table 2: Consonants in Morenthian

Morenthian syllables contain a nucleus consisting of a vowel sound with an optional onset and coda. The maximal syllable structure is (C)(C)(C)V(C)(C)(C). For example, *švrelkt* is one of the most complex syllables. A larger consonant cluster is possible due to the combination of syllables; for example, *sovmkleikt* contains a cluster of four consonants in the middle.

The sounds are selected for no particular reason other than being naturalistic sounding and personal preference. For instance, some phonemes/allophones are included because they are interesting sounds, such as [ø] and [œ]; and the back open unrounded vowel, which is frequent in many languages, including the ones I know. Some sounds influenced by natural languages are the uvular fricative from French and the uvular nasal from Japanese.

The diphthongs in Morenthian include: /aɪ//ao//au//ɑɪ//eɪ//ɪa//ɪɛ//ea//oa//ae//aɛ/.

[1] The inventory was constructed partially based on pre-existing words in the language before any formal grammar for it was written and personal preference for sounds. Although somewhat Indo-European influenced, it should be naturalistic sounding because of how heavily it borrowed from some of the inventories of natural languages (due to my limited exposure to phonology at the time of its creation).

2.2 Romanisation

Phone	Romanisation	Phone	Romanisation
/a/	a	/s/	s
/ɑ/	ä	/ʃ/	š (sh/ch)
/ə/	e	/z/	z
/e/	é	/n/	n
/ɛ/	ë	/h/	h
/ɪ/	i (y)	/j/	y
/o/	o	/l/	l
/y/	u	/ŋ/	nn
/ø/	eu	/ɲ/	gn
/u/	ou	/t͡ʃ/	tch
[iː]	ii	/t͡s/	ts
[œ]	eu	[ʒ]	g
[ʌ]	a	[ɴ]	n
[ɔ]	o	[ç]	s
/ʁ/	r	[χ]	r
/b/	b	/ea/	éa
/m/	m	/ɪa/	ia
/p/	p	/oa/	oa
/t/	t	/ɪɛ/	iie
/d/	d	/ao/	ao
/θ/	th	/ae/	aé
/k/	k	/aɛ/	aë
/g/	g	/aɪ/	ei
/f/	f	/ɑɪ/	ï
/v/	v	/ei/	éi

Table 3: Romanisation of Morenthian

The above table illustrates the romanisation rules of phonemes, allophones, and diphthongs. Some sounds have multiple romanisations, but the romanisation in parentheses is for aesthetic purposes only (the romanisation of a name, for example). When illustrating the phonology/phonotactics, only the main romanisation will be used.

2.3 Phonotactics

Within words, there are several phonological processes that apply to consonant clusters occurring between vowels as illustrated below.

Devoicing of voiced plosives and fricatives: the voiced plosives /b, d, g/ and fricatives /v, z/ are devoiced before the sound [t͡ʃ] when in a cluster not at word-initial or final positions.

/b, d, g, v, z/ → [-voice] / [V]_t͡ʃ[V]

e.g. ëdtchel → [ɛt͡ʃəl]

Deletion

(i) The fricatives are deleted when encountering some other fricative in between vowels:

/v/ → ø / [V]_f[V]

/θ/ → ø / [V]s_[V]

e.g. avfët → [afɛt]

prousthal → [pʁusal]

(ii) The glottal fricative is deleted when occurring intervocalically with a nasal consonant or an approximant:

/h/ → ø / [V][Nasal C]_[V]

/h/ → ø / [V]j_[V]

e.g. lanhët → [lanɛt]

sayholk → [sajolk]

Voicing of voiceless plosives and fricatives: the voiceless plosive /p, t, k/ and fricatives /f, s/ become voiced after [h] when in a cluster not at word-initial or final positions.

/p, t, k, f, s/ → [+voice] / [V]h_[V]

e.g. flähsé → [flɑhze]

Velar nasal becomes alveolar when followed by the liquid [l] in between vowels:

/ŋ/ → [n] / [V]_l[V]

e.g. sannliith → [sanli:θ]

Other phonotactic rules apply to word-initial or word-final consonant clusters.

When /z/ is followed by another consonant at word-final or initial positions, it is devoiced: /z/→ [s] / _C.

e.g. zriithl → [sri:θl]

/g/ is devoiced when followed by the voiced labio-dental fricative at word-final position: /g/ → [k] / v_

e.g. lavg → [lavk]

/d/ is devoiced when it follows the voiceless velar plosive at word-final positions: /d/ → [t] / k_

e.g. aolkd → [aolkt]

And finally, nasals tend to agree in place of articulation with the following stop.

e.g. rovlenb → [ʁovləmb]

2.3.1 Allophones

The following processes produce the allophonic variations of the phonemes shown in tables 1 and 2.

When preceding uvular consonants, /ø/→[œ].

e.g. syeur /sjøʁ/ → [sjœχ]

When preceding uvular consonants in the word-final syllable, /o/→[ɔ].

e.g. rintlor /ʁɪntloʁ/ → [ʁɪntlɔχ]

In the above examples, /ʁ/ is devoiced. It is a general rule that /ʁ/ becomes voiceless at word-final positions: /ʁ/ → [χ] / _#

In word-initial or final positions or preceding /ɛ/, /ɪ/ is pronounced as the front vowel [i(:)].

e.g. atpriëh /atpʁɪɛh/ → [ʌtpʁiɛh]

The above example also illustrates that /ɑ/→[ʌ] when preceding voiceless consonants.

At word-final positions or preceding the uvular /ʁ/, /n/ becomes uvular [ɴ]: /n/ → [ɴ] / _# or _ʁ

e.g. dun → [dyɴ]

Before the front vowels [y ɪ e], /g/ is pronounced as [ʒ]: /g/ → [ʒ] / _[y ɪ e]

e.g. giasv → [ʒɪasv]

When appearing after a vowel followed by the approximant, /s/ is pronounced as the palatal fricative: /s/ → [ç] / Vj_

e.g. loys → [lojç]

2.3.2 Suprasegmentals

Morenthian is a syllable-timed and non-tonal language. Stress is not phonemic and generally undistinctive. Intonation and stress are only used to convey meaning as in distinguishing between statements and questions and the different focuses of an utterance. A rising pitch indicates a question.

3 Morphology

3.1 Nominal Morphology

As Morenthian is a mostly analytic language, noun morphology is limited. There is a small amount of affixing and more free morphemes or particles that serve various purposes.

3.1.1 Definiteness

There is no specialised particle to express definiteness like the English "the". Instead, the word *ne* meaning "this" is used when the speaker wishes to emphasise the definiteness (and in some cases, "that" can also be used). In this case, *ne* follows the noun, unlike other adjectives that usually come before the noun. The use of such particles is optional. There is no word that specifically indicates indefiniteness, but the word "one" can approximate the meaning (but it acts like an adjective and comes before the noun).

(1) *yn* *arikor*
one flower
'a flower'

(2) *arikor* *ne*
flower DEF
'the flower'

3.1.2 Classifier

Classifiers are used when counting or measuring nouns. They follow the numerical quantification. When context allows, the nouns to which classifiers refer can be omitted. There

are two types of classifiers: 1) more common classifiers that have specialised and only serve as classifiers—this is the majority, and 2) nouns that become classifiers by adding the suffix *-il*. This is a rare case of noun inflection, and the class of classifiers is more or less open because of this operation.

(3) *fïmt yn gër*
paper one piece*
'a piece of paper'
**gër*: classifier for thin, flat objects

(4) *klovars kloušeil (ne)*
klovars klouše-il (ne)
person street-CLF (DEF)
'(this) street full of people'

In the case of (4), the classifier implies the presence of more than one person (obviously more than one person is needed to fill a street), and no plural particles are required. As shown in the above examples, the order in which different particles attach to the noun is as follows: *noun (-numeral) -classifier (-demonstrative)*. Classifiers must be included when indicating an amount larger than one (see (5)); the special case of *yn* is described in the *Definiteness* section.

(5) *rein fosfyn fïmt dosar gër*
1SG.INF see paper three piece
'I see three piece of paper'

3.1.3 Plurality

When plurality is not implied through the use of a classifier or the use of adjectives/numbers, similar to definiteness, it can be specified by plural particles. Nouns can be unmarked (ambiguous), or marked for dual/plural, or use the definite article/numbers.

Dur is the plural particle used for describing a group of people.

(6) *ëvhet vars dur*
female person.ABBR PL.HUM
'women'

Note that *ëvhet vars* without the plural can also mean "women", only in that case it is ambiguous.

Kei is the plural particle used for other objects (other than people, i.e. entire persons. This category includes animals, animated things, and body parts.)

(7) *osërv kei*
moon PL.OBJ
'moons'

3.1.4 Possessives

Morenthian distinguishes between alienable/inalienable possessions.

Inalienable possession: noun phrases referring to inalienable possessions (kin and body parts) commonly contain no possessive marker. This is only applicable to humans (i.e., even if something is effectively inalienable of a plant, animal, or object, it uses the possession marker).

(8) *Bari rintlion fël.*
3SG.F wash hand
'She washes her hand.'

When expressing reference to some previously mentioned object, definite articles should be used.

(9) *Bari rintlion fël ne.*
3SG.F wash hand DEF
'She washes *the* hand (that was mentioned earlier).'

When there is both a subordinate clause subject and a main clause subject, unless otherwise specified, the kinship and body part nouns are bound by the closer subject, usually the subordinate clause subject.

Alienable possession: noun phrases referring to alienable possession use the possessive marker *a.* Inalienable possessions, however, can also use this marker for additional emphasis. The noun phrase follows the order *possessor-a-possessee*. Before open vowels /a/ /ɑ/, *a* changes to *al*, pronounced as [ʌl].

(10) *gnyub ne a ranst*
dog DEF GEN address
'the dog's address'

(11) *lu* *al* *arikor*
tree GEN flower
'tree's flower'

Possessive pronouns: use the marker *aen* (also means "from, of" when used to denote family lineage). Names follow the order "family name+*aen*+given name". For example: *Nordelkt* (family name) *aen Ëhelyn* (given name).

(12) *rein* *aen* *gnyub*
1SG.INF GEN dog
'my dog'

3.2 Verbal Morphology

The verbs in Morenthian also have minimal morphology, and tense distinctions are achieved using particles. It is a relatively simple system, and the perfective is marked in the particles as a prefix (which is quite rare). The unmarked mood is indicative or declarative. The progressive describes the category where the event is happening over (before or after) the point of reference, and the label is partly chosen to more conveniently work with its English translation.

3.2.1 Tense, Aspect, Mood

TAM type	**Form**	**Meaning**	**Notes**
Simple present	*Ø*	*Do/Fais*[2]	
Present progressive$_{PRS.PRG/PRS}$	*gyis*	*Be doing* Emphasis, ongoing act	E is true for S±δ
Present perfect$_{PRS.PF}$	*té*	*Have done*	
Simple future$_{FUT}$	*par*	*Will do/Ferai*	
Future progressive$_{FUT.PRG}$	*par gyis*	*Will be doing*	
Future perfect$_{FUT.PF}$	*épar*	*Will have done/Aurai fait*	

[2] I added the French translation mostly for my own reference.

General subjunctive$_{SUB}$	*part*	*Sois*	present + future events
Simple past$_{PST}$	*korf*	*Did/Fis (avoir fait)*	
Past imperfect /progressive$_{PST.PRG}$	*korf gyis*	*Was doing/Faisais* Or a state in the past	
Past perfect$_{PST.PF}$	*ékorf*	*Had done/Avais fait*	
Past subjunctive$_{SUB.PST}$	*koft*	*Would have done/Aie fait*	
General progressive$_{PRG}$	*myëv*	*Have been doing/…depuis* *Always, continuously* adv.	Placed before verbs
Imperative*	*ïsh*	*See below for explanation	
Habituals	*thvaosm*	*Often* adv.	Placed before verbs

Table 4: Tense, aspects, and mood in Morenthian

Example: beulš *v.* to sleep

Rein beulš	I sleep
Rein beulš gyis	I am sleeping
Rein beulš té	I have slept
Rein beulš par	I will sleep
Rein beulš par gyis	I will be sleeping
Rein beulš épar	I will have slept
Rein beulš korf	I slept
Rein beulš korf gyis	I was sleeping
Rein beulš ékorf	I had slept
Rein myëv beulš	I have been sleeping
Rein thvaosm beulš	I often sleep

Telicity:

Telicity is marked with a clitic. The clitic will immediately follow the verb in the case of signalling an atelic event in the perfective. For example, "I have cooked$_{\text{ATEL}}$" would mean that the result was unsuccessful or somewhat unsatisfactory. It can express something like:

(13) *Rein tchlé mu té.*
1SG.INF eat ATEL PRS.PF
'I have eaten (but am not full/did not finish).'

Imperative mood:

The imperative marker is placed after the verb phrase. The particle *ïsh* originally means to hope, wish, or demand, but has now slowly evolved into a grammatical particle to signal the imperative.

Direct order: predicate+marker

(14) *Salt rein ïsh!*
forget 1SG.INF IMP
'Forget me!'

With a subject ("Let us…"): the marker refers to the phrase before it, and the subject immediately follows, inverting the subject position. Depending on the context, this form also indicates a degree of formality.

(15) *Av salt ïsh reinas.*
RCP forget IMP 1PL.IN
'Let's forget each other.'

As shown in (15), *Av* is the word for expressing reciprocal relationships such as "each other, one another". When used with verbs, it precedes the verb it modifies. *Av* can also be used as a reciprocal pronoun. For example, *av al atpriëh* means "each other's language".

(16) *Salt rein ïsh šén.*
forget 1SG.INF IMP 2SG.FOR
'Please forget me.'

645. *Zïsk ïsh, osne šé part ëst dräs.*
quick IMP or else 2SG.INF SUB too late
'Be quick, or you will be too late.'

As shown by example 645*, the copula (verb "to be") can be dropped where the predicate is an adjective phrase. *Sentences with particular numbers are from *Graded Sentences for Analysis*.

3.2.2 Evidentiality

Two morphemes (clitics) code for evidentiality. Their use is optional, and the unmarked phrase contains no particular information about evidentiality.

(i) Witness: *fyn*, derived from the verb *fosfyn* (to see).
(ii) Quotative/hearsay/non-witness: *iié*, derived from the verb *plyé* (to hear).

(17) *Barie rovlenb té fyn*
3SG.M leave PRS.PF WIT
He has left (I saw).'

(18) *Barie rovlenb té plyé*
3SG.M leave PRS.PF NW
He has left (I heard/didn't see).'

4 SYNTAX

4.1 Overview

The primary word order in Morenthian is SVO. Its morphosyntactic alignment is direct/neutral. Therefore, none of the subjects (transitive or intransitive) or objects are marked (see below for the case of ditransitive verbs, which marks the direct object). For example:

(19) *Fïlor ne hiliv.*
bird DEF fly
'The bird flies.'

(20) *Fïlor ne slëbdat šé.*
bird DEF bite 2SG.INF
'The bird bites you.'

(21) *Šé rovlenb.*
2SG.INF walk
'You walk.'

Adjective/adverb phrases:
Adjectives come before the nouns they modify, and adverbs precede the verbs. They are marked by the particle *i* that comes in between the adjective/adverb and the word they modify. A good portion of the adjective and adverb vocabularies overlap with each other as there is no distinction between an adjective and an adverb, and many words can be both an adjective and an adverb depending on what word comes after it.

(22) *zïsk i gnyub*
fast ADJ dog
'a fast dog'

bari zïsk i ayv korf
3SG.M quick ADV say PST
'he said quickly'

Adposition phrases:
Usually, the adposition marker *vei* precedes the phrase, and the postposition is placed at the end of the phrase.

Under	In/inside	At/in front of	Above
hës	ër	ab	sa

Table 5: postpositions in Morenthian

113. *Reinas thvaosm yaëvt ranne vei lu hës.*
1PL.INF often rest here ADP tree under.POST
'We often rest here under the trees.'

121. *Šé myëv flone vei rein aen plaust ab hï?*
2SG.INF PRG write ADP 1SG.INF GEN desk POST Q
'Have you been writing at my desk?'

320. *Rein fosfyn tyïs rintlor kei vei rintl ër.*
1SG.INF see gold fish PL.OBJ ADP water in.POST
'I see some goldfish in the water.'

There are exceptions to the use of the marker *vei*. For example, the postposition *sé,* 'to', does not require a marker preceding the phrase.

(23) *rovlenb kyuran sé*
go east to.POST
'go to the east'

Ditransitive verbs:

Ditransitive verbs such as *give* and *lend* have both a direct and an indirect object (valency=3). In Morenthian, the direct object is marked with the accusative particle *dun* before it.

(24) *Rein dun keimt élion barie.*
1SG.INF ACC book give 3SG.M
'I give the book to him.'

831. *Reine dun šen vënfauth i keimt šväld par šen.*
1SG.FOR ACC 2SG.FOR need ADJ book lend FUT 2SG.FOR
'I shall lend you the books that you need.'

4.2 Question syntax

Polar questions:

To form polar questions, use sentence initial particle *rés*/sentence final particle *hï*/both. Using both particles convey a sense of heightened doubt.

(25) *Rés filor ne slëbdat šé?*
Q bird DEF bite 2SG.INF
'Does the bird bite you?'

(26) *Šé rovlenb hï?*
2SG.INF walk Q
'Do you walk?'

(27) *Rés šé rovlenb hï?*
Q 2SG.INF walk Q
'Do you walk??'

WH questions:

To form WH questions, replace the inquired part of the sentence with corresponding interrogative words such as "what", "where". Question particles are not used in forming these questions.

What	Where	When	Why
Leit	*Leit léirk*	*Leit fé*	*Leit ät*

Table 6: question words in Morenthian

(28) *Barie ësian gyis leit?*
3SG.M read PRS what
'What is he reading?'

(29) *Reinas loyg leit léirk?*
1PL.INCL go where
'Where do we go?'

(30) *Barie leit ät ëmlš té théiz?.*
3SG.M why leave PRS.PF city?
'Why has he left the city?'

4.3 Negation

Negation is achieved using the negation particle. The position of the particle determines the scope of negation.

When it is placed before the verb phrase/predicate, it negates the entire phrase, and the meaning of negation can be ambiguous.

(31) *Rein os fosfyn korf ne vei plaust sa.*
1SG.INF NEG see PST this ADP desk on.POST
'I didn't see this on the desk.'

Depending on the emphasis of utterance, this sentence can mean: it was not on the desk and I did not see it (negating 'see')/I saw it, but it was not on the desk (negating 'on the desk')/I saw something other than this on the desk (negating 'this').

When the particle is placed anywhere else, it negates the closest segment of the sentence/the constituent following it.

(32) *Rein fosfyn korf os ne vei plaust sa.*
1SG.INF see PST NEG this.n ADP desk on.POST
'I didn't see this (lit. 'saw not this') on the desk.'

(33) *Rein fosfyn korf ne os vei plaust sa.*
1SG.INF see PST this.n NEG ADP desk on.POST
'I didn't see this on the desk (lit. 'not on the desk').'

Negation in questions works in a similar way. Question particles or interrogative words are added to the negated phrase to form a question.

(34) *Rés bari os fosfyn korf keimt ne ?*
Q 3SG.M NEG see PST book DEF
'Did he not see the book?'

The answer to a polar question with negation can take multiple forms.
(i) The answer *an* confirms the negated proposition in the question itself. In other situations, it is also used to affirm or express acknowledgement of the statement or question asked. In the above case, it will mean "You are right; he didn't see the book".
(ii) The answer *lan* confirms the proposition in the question, i.e., without negation. It means 'yes' in normal polar questions. In the above example, this answer means "Yes, he saw the book".
(iii) The answer *aii*, meaning 'no' in general, indicates agreement with the negated proposition in this case. In the above example, this answer would mean "No, he didn't see the book".

4.3 Relative clause

The relative clause is treated like an extended adjective phrase. They precede the phrase they modify and are connected with the marker *i*.

886. *Dun sovmkleikt gnévt reinat i klovars dur krivan i šléfr*
ACC news tell 1PL.EXCL ADJ person PLU.HUM certain ADV believe
korf gyis bar aen sivët.
PST.PRG it GEN truth
'The people who told us the news were certain of its truth.'

3. *Reine fosfyn korf šen vënfauth i keimt.*
1SG.FOR see PST 2SG.FOR need ADJ book
'I saw the books that you need.'

819. *Rés šé prévl té brasdnor envul korf i irkis triiv*
Q 2SG.INF return PRS.PF yesterday borrow PST ADJ umbrella (lit. rain -cover)
'Have you returned the umbrella that you borrowed yesterday?'

When the subject for both the main clause and the relative clause is the same, the relative clause can omit the subject.

1002. *Reine os štotvl korf leit léirk barnas loyg korf.*
1SG.FOR NEG notice PST where 3PL go PST
'I did not notice where they went.'

5 Miscellaneous

5.1 Number system

Morenthian started with an octal number system. The numbers 1-7 and the base 8 borrowed names of deities.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	8^2	8^3
yn	ol	dosar	kyu	sïn	vin	sur	yväl	étéri-ol	étéri-dosar

Table 7: Morenthian numbers (octal)

e.g. 93 (base 10) = $8^2 \cdot 1 + 8 \cdot 3 + 5$

étéri-ol né étéri dosar né sïn

8^2 and 8^1 3 and 5

This can also be abbreviated in speech or informal writing to: *olé dosaré sïn*

9	10
vayn	säp

Table 8: Additional numbers

Morenthian later evolved a decimal system due to contact with another culture, *Ledja*, which is more mathematically advanced and uses the decimal system. The word for 10 is a loan word from the Ledja language. Present-day use of the octal system is limited to religious events and formal ceremonies and invokes a sense of formality.

Example

e.g. 93=*vayn étéri né dosar*

9 base (10) and 3

Abbreviated to: *vayné dosar*

Ordinals:

Ordinals are formed by adding *flär* before the number. To indicate the order of objects, the phrase functions like an adjective phrase, and classifiers are not required. If desired, the classifier can be incorporated as shown by (36).

(35) *flär kyu i keimt*

ORD four ADJ book

'the fourth book'

(36) *véyf flär kyu flonn*

tower ORD four $CLF_{\text{large inanimate object}}$

'the fourth tower'

5.2 Writing System

Morenthian uses an alphabet. The glyphs do not have a particular language as the source of inspiration but simply the general aesthetic of cursive letters from the latin alphabet.



Figure 1: The Morenthian alphabet

Sample sentences with the Morenthian script:

615. *Ënše, rés šé os dyisf rein?*
son Q 2SG.INF NEG know 1SG.INF
'Do you not know me, my son?'

846. *Rés šé fosfyn té varše dur drämp korf i arikor?*
Q 2SG.INF see PRS.PF child PL.HUM bring PST ADJ flower
'Have you seen the flowers that the children brought?'

982. *Šé hësn rum klofše né šlarv slämt hï?*
2SG.INF want all.adj door and window open Q
'Do you want all the doors and windows open?'

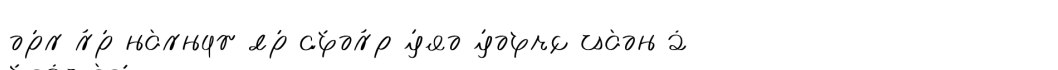
998. *Dun šé vrïglits rum i bar gnévt rein ïsh.*
ACC 2SG.INF know all.adj ADJ 3SG tell 1SG.INF IMP
'Tell me all you know about it.'

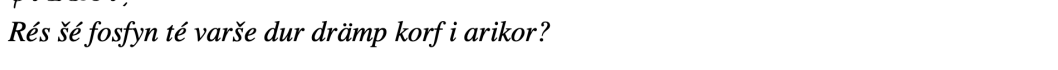
1003. *Švaël giasv korf i ïsh lyodefeu korf barnas.*
help.n near.v PST ADJ hope comfort PST 3PL
'The hope that help was near comforted them.'

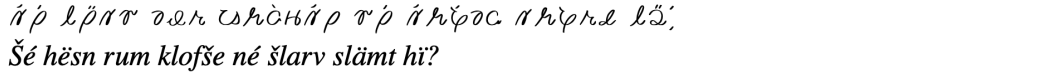
1007. *Keinlär vëd ézié reinas vourk loyg leit léirk*
important question be 1PL.INCL shall go where
'The important question is, "Where shall we go?"'

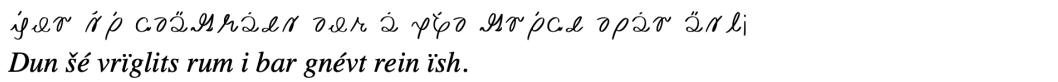
1033. *Olereif isbëst i léirk ézié korf yn gnit krësldaerd.*
light emanate ADJ place be PST a small place of worship (equivalent of chapel)
'The place from which the light proceeded was a small chapel.'

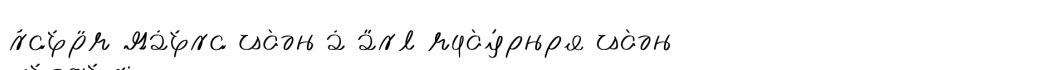

Ënše, rés šé os dyisf rein?

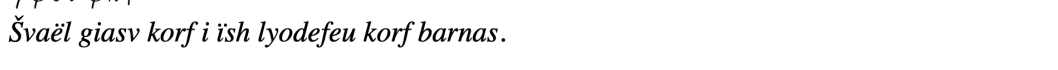

Rés šé fosfyn té varše dur drämp korf i arikor?


Šé hësn rum klofše né šlarv slämt hï?


Dun šé vrïglits rum i bar gnévt rein ïsh.


Švaël giasv korf i ïsh lyodefeu korf barnas.


Keinlär vëd ézié reinas vourk loyg leit léirk.


Olereif isbëst i léirk ézié korf yn gnit krësldaerd.

6 Lexicon & Literature

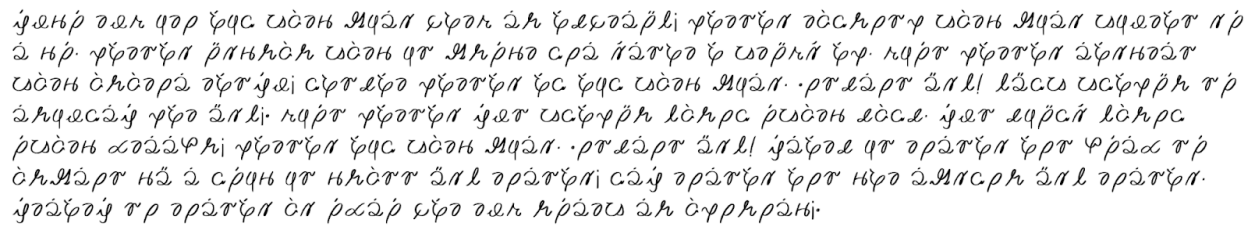
6.1 Translation

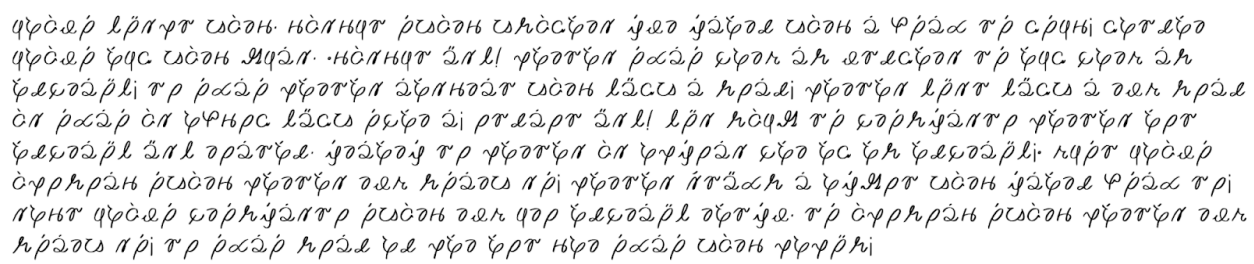
By tradition, the following is a translation of the story of the Tower of Babel from Genesis 11:1-9.

Romanised[3]:

> Dufé rum yre ayv korf gyis pärm il atpriëh. Barnas rovlenb korf gyis kyuran sé i fé, barnas ësflol korf yn gléfr vei šinär a krëmš ab, myén barnas iasfrin korf olorei randu. Väntar barnas av ayv korf gyis: “Entien ïsh! Hïvk kvabël né ilyuvid bar ïsh.” Myén barnas dun kvabël holev ékorf tovt, dun tyëvš holev ékorf zriithl. Barnas ayv korf gyis: “Entien ïsh! Diart yn reinas aen théiz né olgien fï i véyf yn flonn ïsh reinas. Vid reinas aen fär igsvel ïsh reinas, driard ne reinas os ézié par rum léirk il obeleif.”
>
> Yäoué hësbn korf, fosfyn ékorf klovars dur diart korf i théiz né véyf. Väntar yäoué ayv korf gyis: “Fosfyn ïsh! Barnas ézié pärm il untvars né ayv pärm il atpriëh. Ne ézié barnas iasfrin korf hïvk i leit. Barnas hësn hïvk i rum leit os ézié os äthfev hïvk épar i. Entien ïsh! Hës loyg né préldisne barnas aen atpriëh ïsh reinat, driard ne barnas os äbdeis par av al atpriëh.” Myén yäoué obeleif ékorf barnas rum léirk sé. Barnas šnïzl i ädgen korf diart théiz ne. Säfn yäoué préldisne ékorf rum yre atpriëh randu, né obeleif ékorf barnas rum léirk sé. Ne ézié leit ät bar aen fär ézié korf bäbël.

Conscript:





[3] Punctuations and sentence-initial capitalisation are added per English convention for clarity.

Glossed:

Dufé rum yre ayv korf gyis pärm il atpriëh. Barnas rovlenb korf gyis
that time all.adj world speak PST.PRG same ADJ language 3PL walk/travel PST.PRG
Now all the earth continued to be of one language and of one vocabulary. As they travelled

kyuran sé i fé, barnas ësflol korf yn gléfr vei šinär a krëmš ab,
east to.POST ADJ time 3PL discover PST a valley ADP Shinar GEN land at.POST
eastward, they discovered a valley plain in the land of Shinar,

myén barnas iasfrin korf olorei randu. Väntar barnas av ayv korf gyis: Entien ïsh!
then/hence 3PL start PST live there then 3PL RCP say PST.PGR come IMP
and they began dwelling there. Then they said to one another: "Come!

Hïvk kvabël né ilyuvid bar ïsh. Myén barnas dun kvabël holev ékorf tovt,
make brick and bake 3SG.N IMP hence 3PL ACC brick use as PST.PF stone
Let us make bricks and bake them with fire." So they used bricks instead of stone,

dun tyëvš holev ékorf zriithl. Barnas ayv korf gyis: Entien ïsh! Diart yn reinas
ACC bitumen use as PST.PF mortar 3PL say PST.PGR come IMP build a 1PL.INCL
and bitumen as mortar. They now said: "Come! Let us build a city for ourselves

aen théiz né olgien fi i véyf yn flonn ïsh reinas. Vid reinas
GEN city and reach sky ADJ tower one $CLF_{\text{large inanimate object}}$ IMP 1PL.INCL make 1PL.INCL
and a tower with its top in the heavens, and let us

aen fär igsvel ïsh reinas, driard ne reinas os ézié par rum léirk
GEN name celebrated IMP 1PL.INCL so $that_{\text{lit: after this}}$ 1PL.INCL NEG be FUT everywhere
make a celebrated name for ourselves, so that we will not be scattered over the entire face of the

il obeleif. Yäoué hësbn korf, fosfyn ékorf klovars dur diart korf i théiz né
ADV scattered Yahweh descend PST see PST.PF humankind build PST ADJ city and
Earth." Then Yahweh went down to see the city and the tower that the sons of men had built.

véyf. Väntar yäoué ayv korf gyis: Fosfyn ïsh! Barnas ézié pärm il untvars né
tower then Yahweh say PST.PRG look IMP 3PL be same ADJ people/nation and
Yahweh then said: "Look! They are one people with one language,

ayv pärm il atpriëh. Ne ézié barnas iasfrin korf hïvk i leit. Barnas hësn
speak same ADJ language this be 3PL start PST do ADJ thing 3PL want
and this is what they have started to do. Now there is nothing that they may have in mind to do
hïvk i rum leit os ézié os äthfev hïvk épar i. Entien ïsh! Hës loyg
do ADJ all thing NEG be NEG can do FUT.PF ADJ. come IMP go down
that will be impossible for them. Come! Let us go down there
né préldisne barnas aen atpriëh ïsh reinat, driard ne barnas os äbdeis par
and confuse 3PL GEN language IMP 1PL.EXCL so that 3PL NEG understand FUT
and confuse their language in order that they may not understand one another's language."
av al atpriëh. Myén yäoué obeleif ékorf barnas rum léirk sé. Barnas
each other GEN language hence Yahweh scatter PST.PF 3PL everywhere to.POST 3PL
So Yahweh scattered them from there over the entire face of the earth,
šnïzl i ädgen korf diart théiz ne. Säfn yäoué préldisne ékorf rum yre al
gradually ADV stop PST build city DEF because Yahweh confuse PST.PF all.adj world GEN
and they gradually left off building the city. That is why it was named Babel, because there
atpriëh randu, né obeleif ékorf barnas rum léirk sé. Ne ézié leit ät bar aen
language there and scatter PST.PF 3PL all.adj world to.POST this be why 3SG.N GEN
Yahweh confused the language of all the earth, and Yahweh scattered them from there over the
fär ézié korf bäbël.
name be PST Babel
entire face of the earth.

6.2 Lexicon

Morenthian	Translation	Morenthian	Translation
äbdeis	understand	leit	thing
ädgen	stop	loyg	go
arikor	flower	lu	tree
atpriëh	language	lyodefeu	comfort
av	each other	myén	then, hence
ayv	say, speak	obeleif	scattered
beulš	sleep	olereif	light
diart	build	olgien	reach
drämp	bring	olor	life
dräs	late	olorei	live
dufé	then, that time	osërv	moon
dyisf	know (someone)	pärm	same
élion	give	plaust	desk
ëmlš	leave (transitive)	préldisne	confuse
ënše	son	prévl	return
envul	borrow	ranne	here
ësflol	discover	ranst	address
ësian	read	rintl	water
ëst	too	rintlion	wash
ëvhet	female	rovlenb	leave, go, walk
ézié	be	rum	all
fël	hand	rum léirk	everywhere
fi	sky	salt	forget
filor	bird	sivët	truth
fimt	paper	slämt	open
flone	write	šlarv	window
fosfyn	see	slëbdat	bite

giasv	near (v.)
gléfr	valley plain
gnévt	tell
gnit	small
gnyub	dog
hësbn	come down
hësn	want
hiliv	fly
hïvk	do, make
holev	use as (ditransitive)
iasfrin	start
igsvel	celebrated
ilyuvid	burn, bake
irkis triiv	umbrella
isbëst	emanate
keimt	book
keinlär	important
klofše	door
klouše	street
klovars	person, human
krëmš	land
krësldaerd	place of worship (equivalent of a chapel)
krivan	certain
kvabël	brick
kyuran	east
léirk	place
šléfr	believe
šnïzl	gradual
sovmkleikt	news
štotvl	notice
švaël	help
šväld	lend
tchlé	eat
théiz	city
thvaosm	often
tyëvš	bitumen
tyïs rintlor	gold fish
untvars	nation, people
vars	person (abbreviated)
varše	child
vëd	question
vënfauth	need
véyf	tower
vid	make
vourk	shall, should
vrïglits	know (something)
yaëvt	rest
yre	word, time
zïsk	quick, fast
zriithl	mortar

Appendix

Pronouns in Morenthian

	SG	PL.INCL	PL.EXCL
1.INF	rein	reinas	reinat
1.FOR	reine		
2.INF	šé	šénas	
2.FOR	šen	šénnas	
3	bar/barie/bari	barnas	